

PORTFOLIO

GRAPHIC DESIGN

2020

—

2025

MAURICIO ORTEGA RAMOS



KNOWLEDGE

ADOBE PHOTOSHOP ADOBE INDESIGN
ADOBE ILLUSTRATOR ADOBE PRIMER PRO
ADOBE XD ADOBE AFTER EFFECTS

PROFILE AND CONTACT

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EDUCATION

MOUNTIAN LAND TECHAL COLLAGE
DIGITAL MEDIA
HIGHSCHOOL GRADUATE
CURRENT UVU STUDENT

WORK EXPERIENCE

2020-2021: INTERN DREAMSTOCK MEDIA
2020-2023: FREELANCE

HOBBIES & INTRESTS

MOVIE / PODCAST / TEA BREWING
NAPPING / STREET ART/ SPRAY PAINT

2

IMAGE MANIPULATION

6

VECTOR ILLUSTRATION

10

DESKTOP PUBLISHING

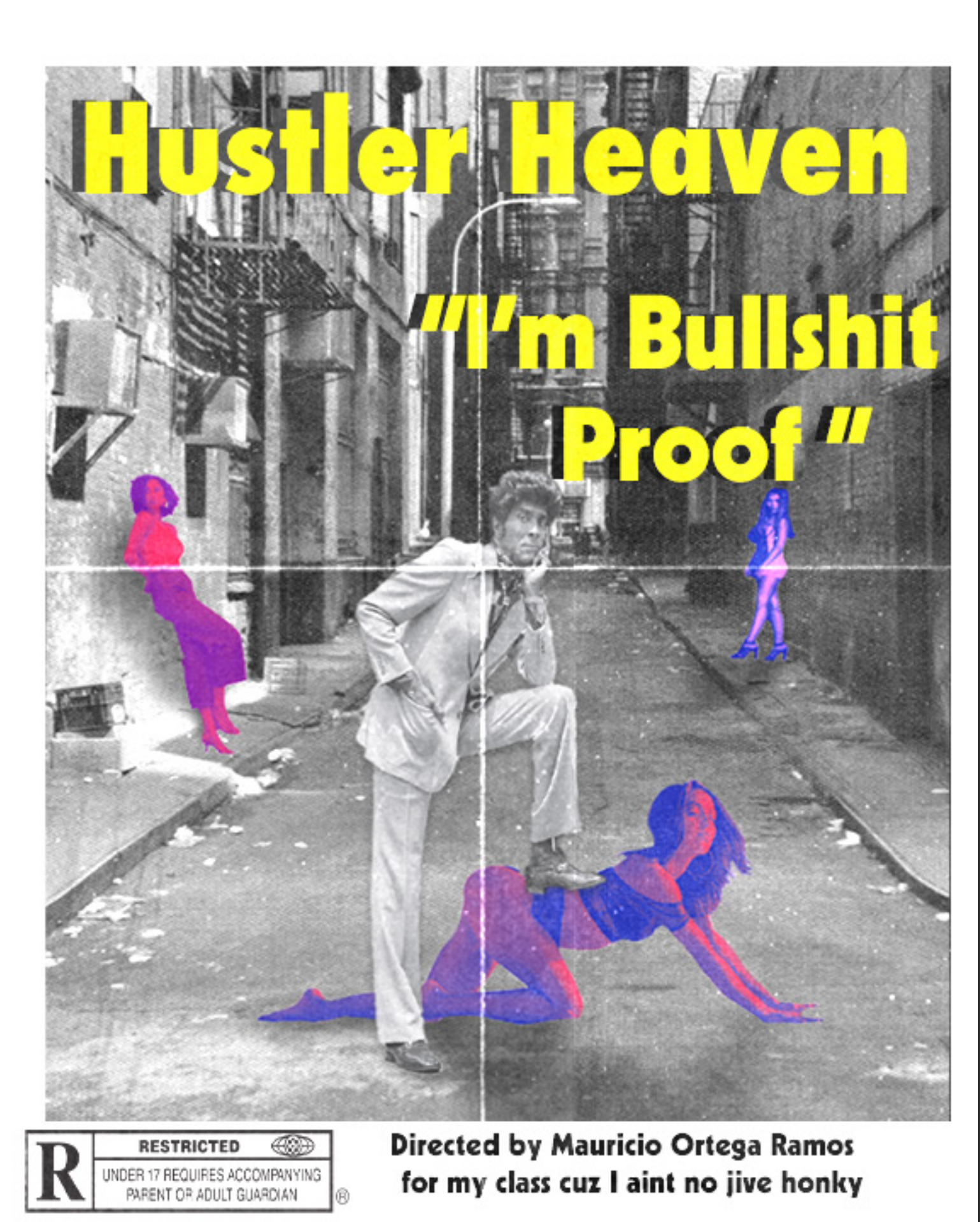
14

VIDEO AND GRAPHICS

2

IMAGE MANIPULATION





6

VECTOR ILLUSTRATION



Wu-tang clan

— verbal assault tour —

November

- 01. Jessup, PA
- 02. Benton, ME
- 03. Mojave, CA
- 04. Bedford, IN
- 05. Beachwood, NJ

- 06. Crawfordvill, GA
- 07. Gainesville, MO
- 08. Fruit Cove, FL
- 09. DeMotte, IN
- 10. Salt lake city, UT



2

DESKTOP PUBLISHING





The origins of sign painting date back to ancient civilizations. From the hieroglyph-covered walls of Egypt to Roman inscribed stone tablets, humans have always sought to make their messages visible and compelling. The rise of sign painting as we recognize it today began in medieval Europe. Guilds and tradespeople would use pictorial signs to advertise their services to an often illiterate populace—think of a golden boot hanging outside a cobbler's shop or a frothy tankard marking a pub. By the 18th and 19th centuries, literacy rates had climbed, and businesses started incorporating bold lettering and artistic flourishes to grab attention. The Industrial Revolution brought an explosion of commerce, and with it came the golden age of sign painting. Skilled artisans used brushes, mahl sticks, and pots of vibrant enamel paint to create striking advertisements on buildings, storefronts, and vehicles. In America, the 20th century saw sign painters become integral to the booming economy, leaving their mark on diners, department stores, and bustling cityscapes. Iconic signs like the Coca-Cola wall ads or the neon-painted façades of Route 66 landmarks wouldn't exist without these talented hands.

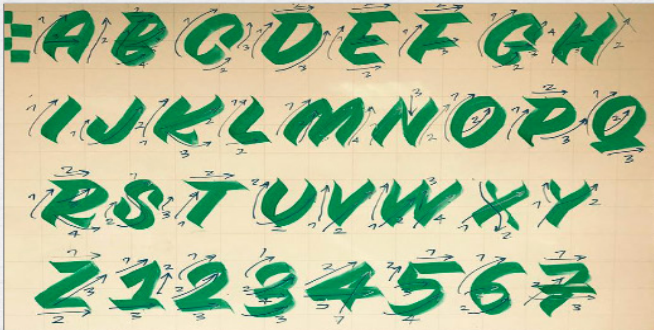


Materials & Resources

- 1. Paints**
Enamel Paints: Durable and glossy (e.g., 1 Shot).
Acrylic Paints: Quick-drying and easy to use.
- 2. Brushes**
Lettering Brushes: For clean, precise lines.
Flat Brushes: For bigger areas and bold strokes.
- 3. Surfaces**
Wood: Prepped with primer.
Glass: For windows or reverse painting.
Metal: Clean and primed.
- 4. Tools**
Mahl Stick: Helps steady your hand.



Practice Practice Practice Practice



In today's world of digital design and automated processes, the craft of sign painting remains a timeless testament to the beauty of the human touch. A single bold stroke or a perfectly curved letter captures not only attention but the soul of a message. While the tools of the trade—like mahl sticks, quality brushes, and One Shot enamels—are cherished by professionals, the heart of sign painting lies in the practice. You don't need all the materials or a perfect setup to start refining your craft. Whether it's sketching letters in the margins of a notebook or exploring graffiti tagging on a wall, every gesture brings you closer to mastery.

Practicing Without the "Right" Tools

Many budding sign painters hesitate to start because they lack specialized materials. Here's a truth: the art form isn't bound by the tools in your kit but by your willingness to improve your eye, hand, and style.

- Sketch and Doodle:** Start with pencil and paper. Work on drawing letters in different weights, sizes, and scripts. Practice your spacing and layouts—skills that will translate directly to your painting later.
- Chalk and Sidewalks:** If you're lacking a surface to practice large-scale lettering, try using chalk on a sidewalk or wall. It's temporary but lets you play with big, bold strokes.
- Dry Runs:** Even a dry brush on a blank surface can help develop muscle memory. Focus on creating smooth, confident strokes—repetition builds mastery.

Graffiti Tagging as a Tool for Growth

Street art, especially graffiti, often intersects with sign painting in surprising ways. Both disciplines demand precision, style, and the ability to convey a message visually. Here's how tagging or "checking" (repeatedly practicing tags) can help sharpen your craft:

- Line Confidence:** The fluidity required in tagging teaches you to trust your hand. This translates directly to steady strokes in sign painting.
- Flow and Style:** Tags are about personality. They push you to explore how small details—an exaggerated curve or a sharp angle—can transform a simple word into a dynamic statement.
- Speed and Adaptability:** The fast-paced nature of graffiti forces you to work efficiently, an invaluable skill for commercial sign work.

Beyond Letters: The Art of Observation

No matter the medium, your progression as a sign painter depends on how you observe the world around you. Analyze the signs on your morning commute. Study their layouts, the harmony of their colors, and the weight of their letters. Try replicating these signs in your own sketches. As you practice, you'll begin to internalize these techniques, making them your own.

The Creative Crossroads

While graffiti and sign painting may seem like distant cousins, they share a common denominator: creativity without boundaries. A tag on a train car may inspire a bold script on a cafe window. A letter meticulously painted on a mural may influence the refinement of a signature tag. Both are testaments to the idea that practice in any form feeds the artist's soul. So, whether you have the finest enamel paints or a handful of crayons, keep drawing, sketching, tagging, and painting. Every line matters.

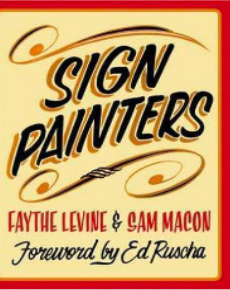
"WE'VE GOTTA BE TWICE AS PERFECT AS ANYBODY ELSE"

—edward James Olmos

The Chicano cholo style is more than just fashion—it's a powerful expression of identity for Mexican-American youth caught between two cultures. Rooted in the streets of America, this style emerged in the mid-20th century as a response to the struggles of fitting in both American and Mexican societies. With its distinctive elements—sharp creased pants, oversized flannel shirts, bandanas, tattoos, and lowrider cars—the cholo aesthetic speaks volumes about pride, resistance, and resilience. For many Mexican-American youth, cholo style becomes a way to assert their presence in a world that often rejects them. In the U.S., it's misunderstood as a symbol of gang culture, while in Mexico, it can be seen as too Americanized. Yet, this dual rejection gives rise to a unique identity—a Chicano identity that blends elements of both cultures while rejecting the need to fully belong to either. Cholo style also serves as a form of art and rebellion. Tattoos honor indigenous roots, while the lowrider car culture symbolizes a sense of community and creativity. The look is both a nod to history and a statement of resilience in modern life, capturing the beauty of cultural hybridity. Ultimately, cholo style is a visual commentary on the Mexican-American experience: not fully accepted in either America or Mexico, yet proudly carving out its own space. It's a celebration of self-love and defiance, a reminder that identity is something to be embraced, not erased.



The Chicano cholo style is a powerful commentary on the complexities of being Mexican-American. It captures the essence of navigating a world where belonging is elusive and identity is constantly negotiated. At its core, cholo style is a declaration of self-love and cultural pride. It reminds us that beauty can arise from struggle, that identity is not static but a mosaic of experiences, and that sometimes, the best way to resist is simply to be unapologetically yourself. In an America where the pressures of assimilation often dilute cultural expression, cholo style stands defiant, a bold testament to the richness of being "ni de aquí, ni de allá"—not from here, not from there, but something beautifully in between.



A GREAT READ !!! :

Sign Painters by Faythe Levine and Sam Macon celebrates the artistry and history of hand-painted signs. Featuring interviews and photos, it highlights the craft's cultural impact, its decline, and its modern revival through the passion of dedicated artists.

